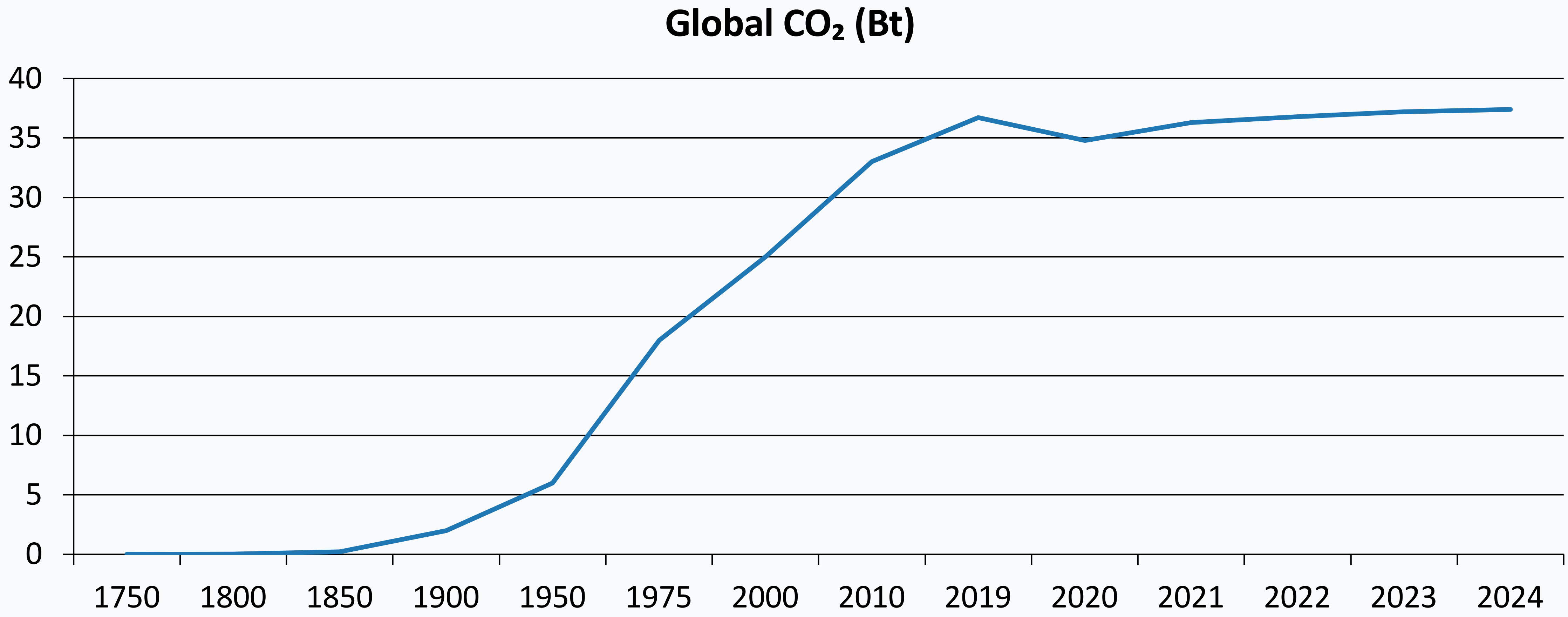
Global CO_2 Emissions: Who Emits, How Much, and What's Changing

Scope: Fossil fuels & industry CO_2 emissions, 1750–2024

Audience: Policy analysts, climate negotiators, sustainability researchers

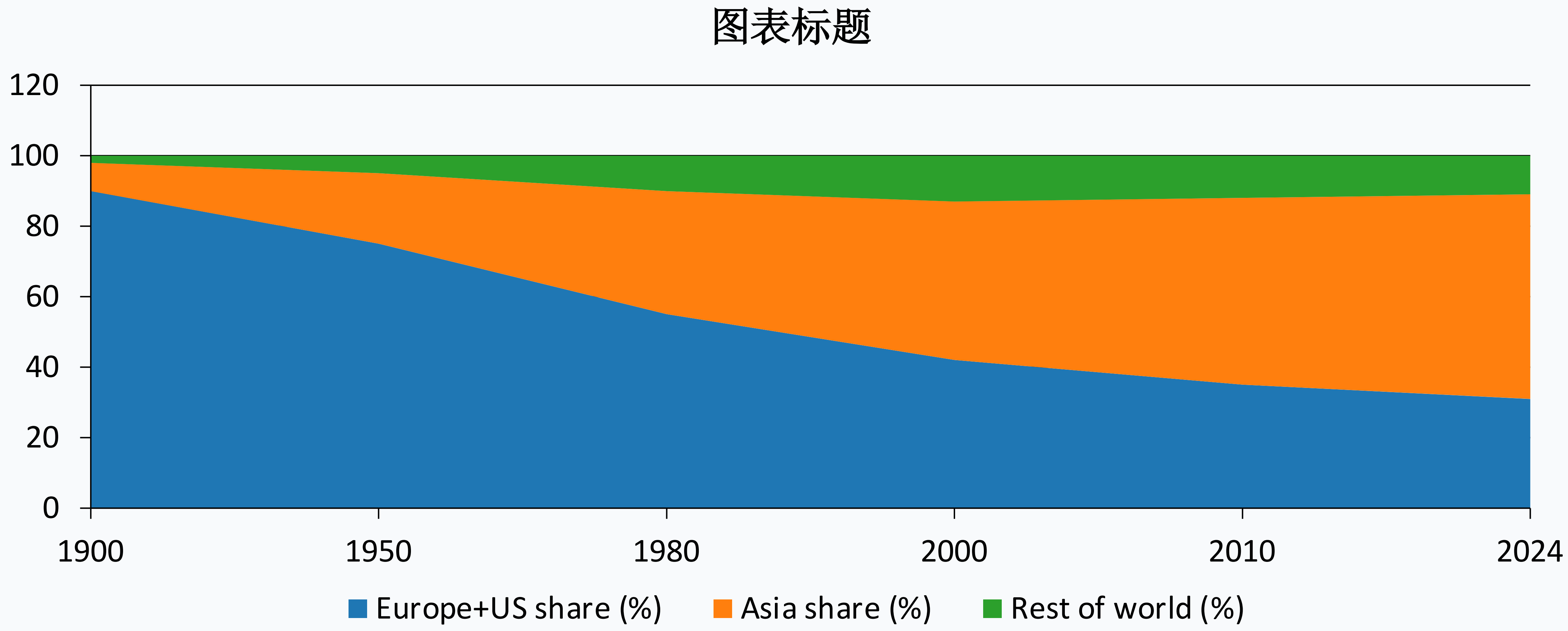
Data source: Global Carbon Budget 2025 via Our World in Data

Global CO_2 Emissions Grew from 6 Bt in 1950 to Over 35 Bt Today

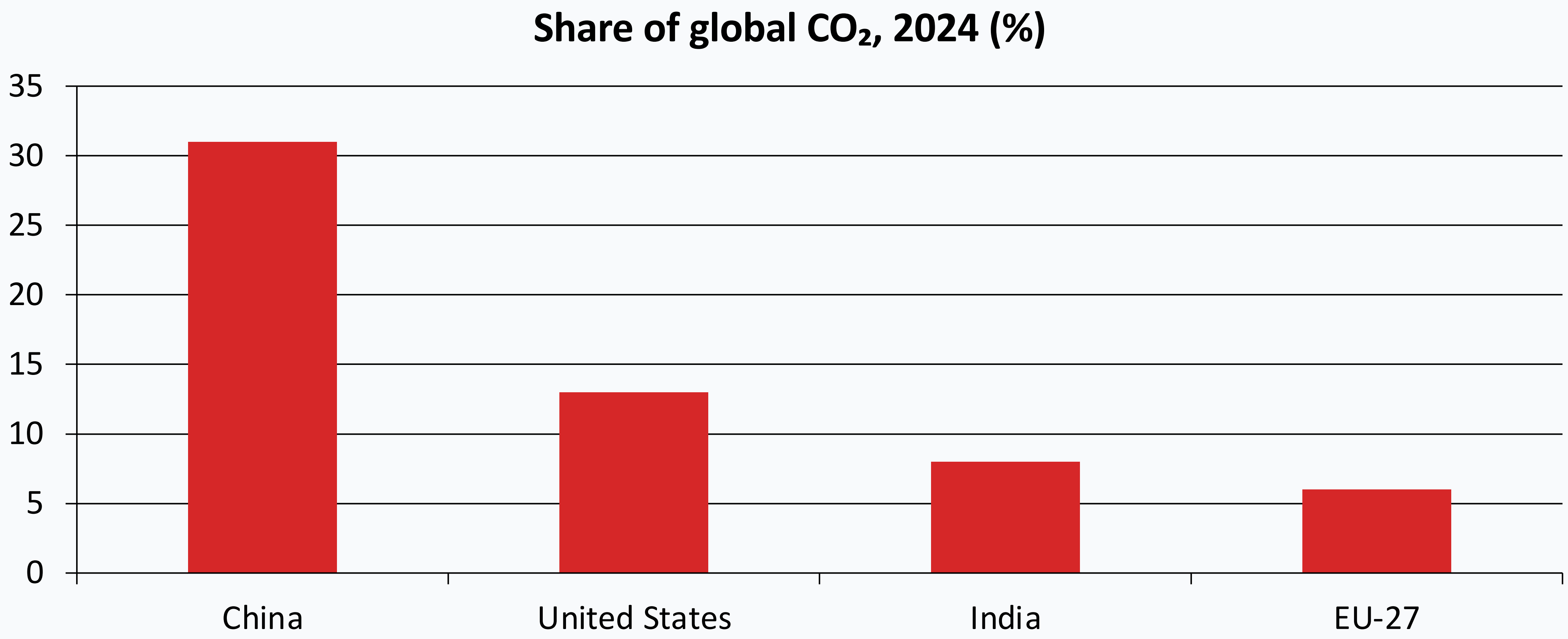


Inflection points: slow pre-industrial growth → post-1950 acceleration → recent slowing, but no peak yet.

Europe and the US Fell from 90% of Emissions in 1900 to Under One-Thir

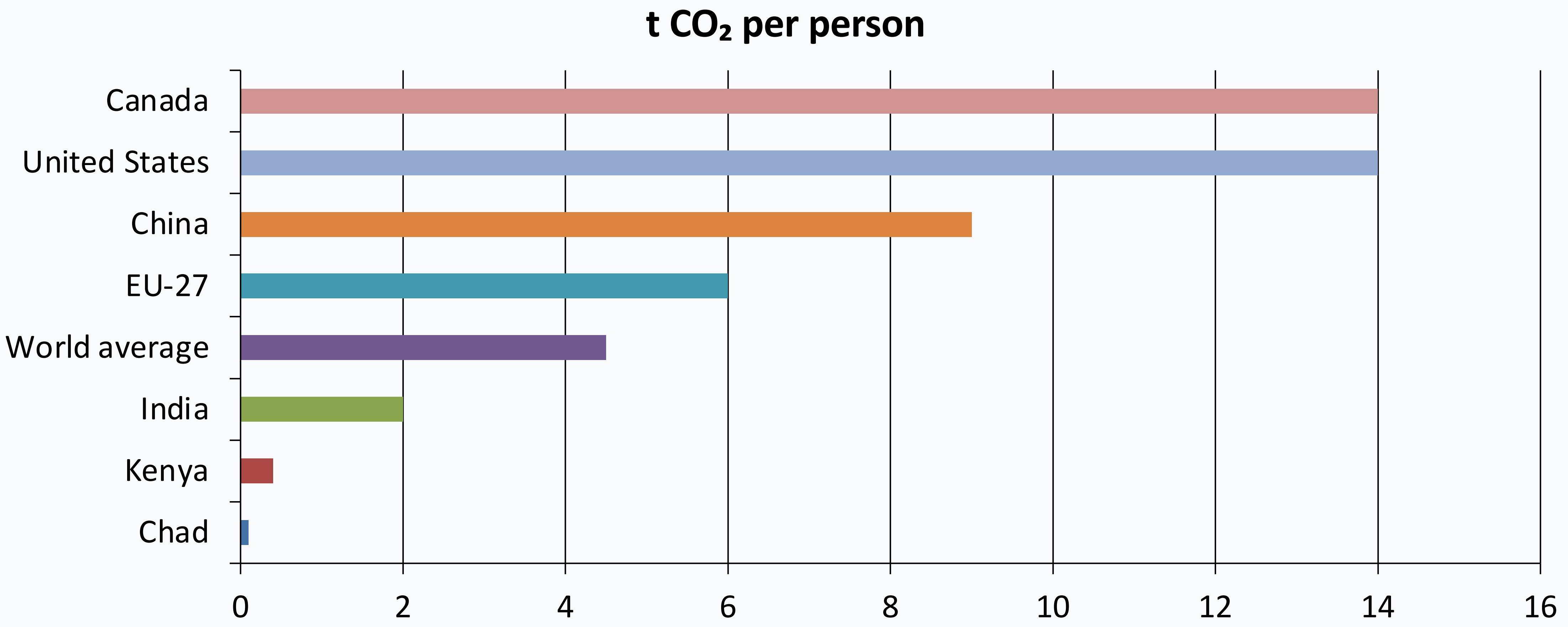


China Now Emits More Than One-Quarter of Global CO_2



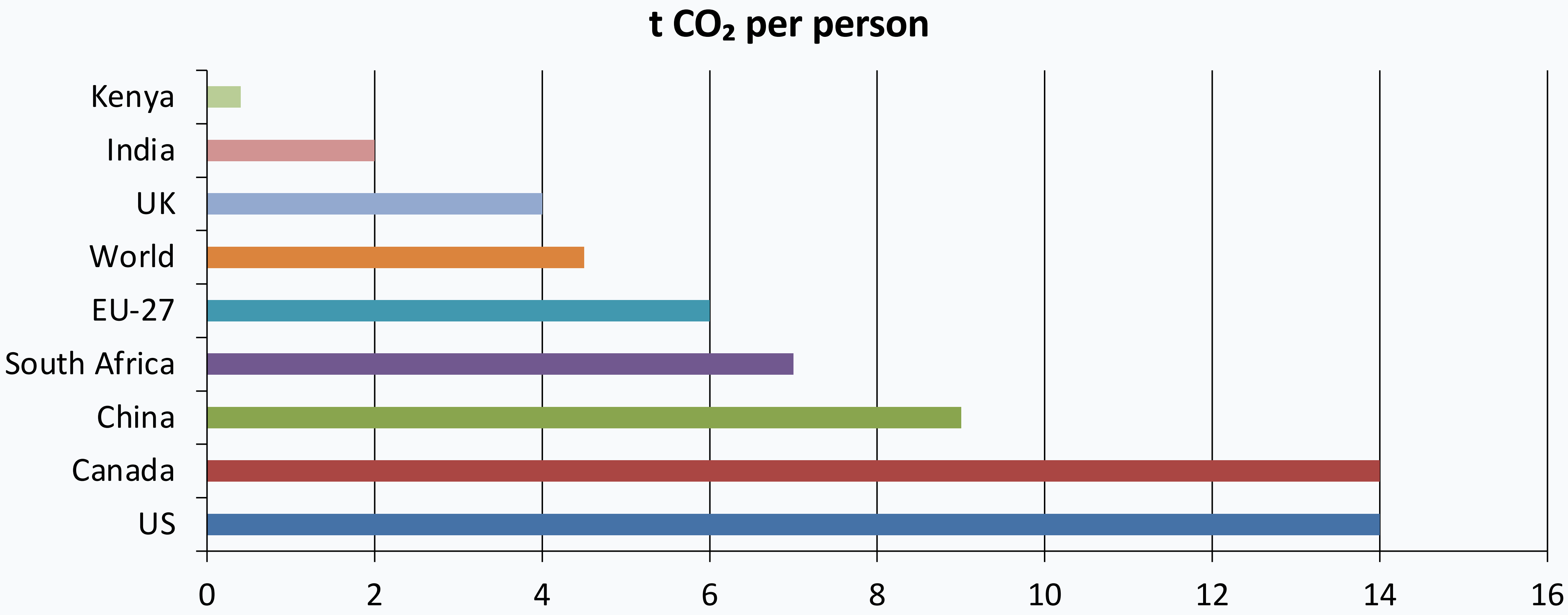
Country-level shares from source brief slide specifications (2024 snapshot).

Per Capita Emissions Range from 0.1 t in Chad to ~14 t in the US and Cana



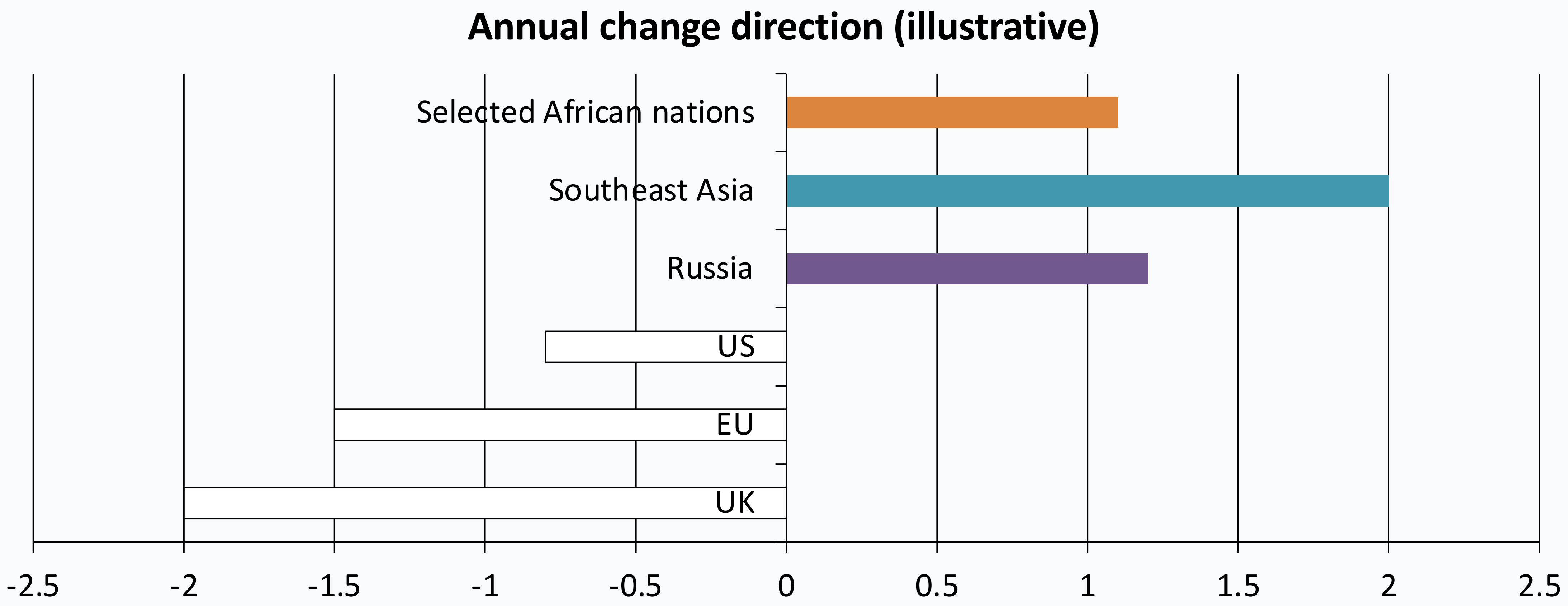
Approximate 150× gap between lowest and highest country values in slide brief (0.1 vs ~14 t/person).

Per Capita Emissions Vary Widely: ~14 t in the US vs. ~9 t in China and ~2



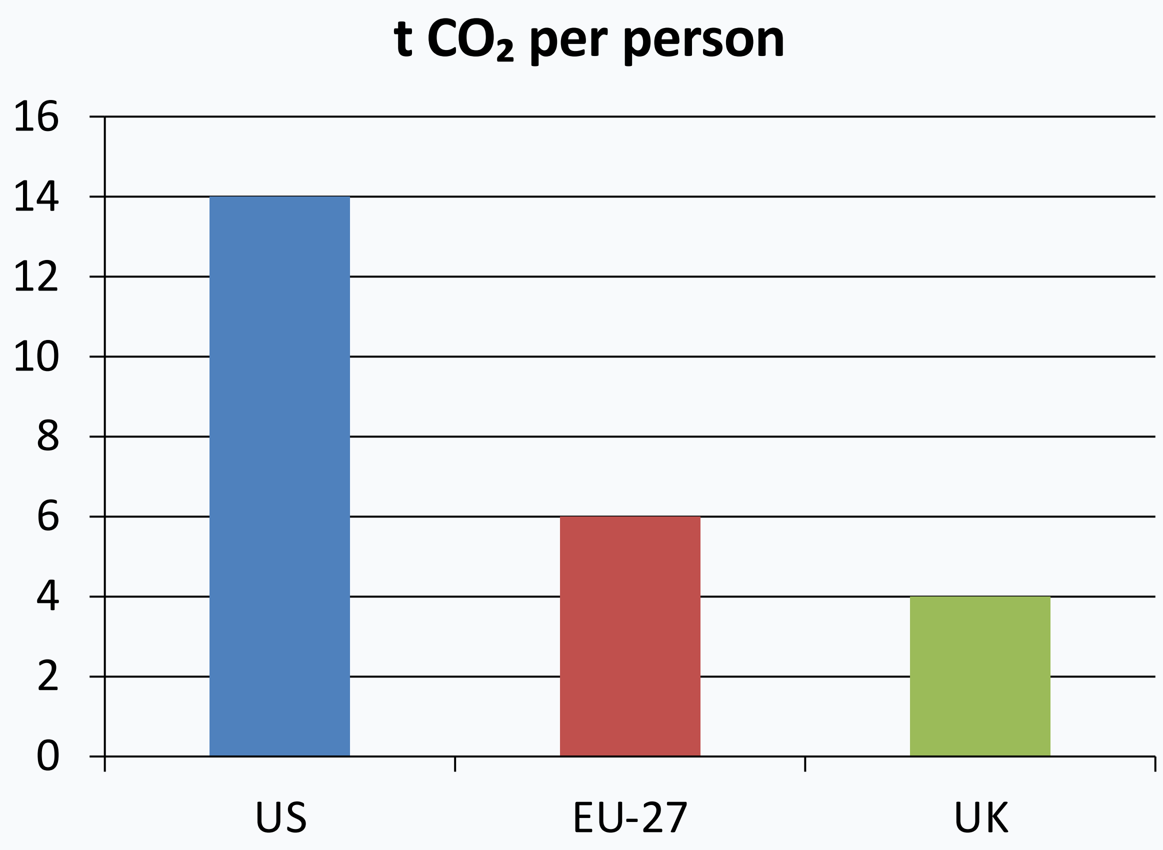
China remains below US per-capita levels despite being the largest total emitter; India remains much lower.

2024 Snapshot: Many Western Nations Cut Emissions While Parts of Asia



Diverging bars represent direction described in the brief: declines in US/EU/UK, increases in parts of Asia and Africa.

Energy Mix Explains Why France and the UK Emit Far Less Per Capita Thar



- Among similarly wealthy economies, per-capita emissions differ sharply.
- France, the UK, and Portugal are lower than Germany, the Netherlands, and the US.
- A key reason is energy mix: higher nuclear/renewable shares vs. fossil fuel dependence.

Key Takeaways: Responsibility Is Shared but Unequal

- Global emissions now exceed 35 Bt CO_2 per year and have not yet peaked.
- China is the largest annual emitter, but its per-capita emissions remain below the US.
- Historical responsibility is still dominated by Europe and the United States.
- Per-capita gaps of about 150× persist between the poorest and richest emitters.
- Energy policy and technology choices can decouple prosperity from emissions.